University of Florida
College of Public Health & Health Professions Syllabus

PHC 6251: Assessment & Surveillance in Public Health (3 credits)

Delivery Format: *Online*

https://ufl.instructure.com/courses/552165

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Office Hours: Please email to arrange time to meet virtually/in person.
Teaching Assistants: *TBD*
Preferred Course Communications: *email, Zoom*

Prerequisites

- PHC 6410 Psychological, Social, & Behavioral Issues in Public Health
  and
- PHC 6050 Statistical Methods for Health Science I **OR** PHC 6052 Introduction to Biostatistical Methods

PURPOSE AND OUTCOME

Course Overview

This course is designed to provide students with the knowledge, skills, and methods for conducting community health assessments and surveillance to inform design of social and behavioral interventions.

Relation to Program Outcomes

This course is associated with the MPH Social and Behavioral Sciences competency of:

- *Design and conduct a community needs assessment.*

Course Objectives and/or Goals

Upon successful completion of the course, students will be able to:

1. *Explain the purpose of conducting community assessments and public health surveillance.*
2. *Work as a group to negotiate roles/work plans for conducting a comprehensive assessment.*
3. *Develop partnerships with community members, organizations, and stakeholders.*
4. *Determine appropriate assessment methods.*
5. *Demonstrate the skills necessary to:*
   a. *develop rigorous assessment-related materials that are IRB and community approved.*
   b. *conduct primary and secondary data collection and analyses*
6. *Report findings from an assessment.*
7. *Communicate findings to stakeholders.*
8. *Create a comprehensive plan for conducting a community assessment.*
9. *Identify appropriate data collection instruments and methods.*

Instructional Methods *(optional)*

Instructor Note about Online Learning: Be aware that online learning can present significant challenges, particularly to those who are not 'self-starters' or those who do not possess good time management skills. The online classroom is available to you 24 hours a day. Unlike traditional instructional settings in which each student gets the same class, the online setting means that every student will participate in the course that they choose to experience. In theory, this type of instruction should be more adaptable to a variety of learning styles. The reality is, however, that some students seem unwilling (we believe all are able) to create and actively participate in their own virtual classroom. This often results in procrastination and low-quality performance. Recognizing that everyone learns differently, I will not prescribe

the ‘best way’ to approach the course. You should note, however, that this course is not self-paced. I expect you to adhere to the class calendar and timeline I have developed for you (see Course Schedule). I do recognize that personal circumstances arise (i.e., life happens) that may interfere with your ability to meet a deadline. If these unanticipated events do occur, please let me know as soon as possible. I will not be receptive to retrospective requests for extensions without a compelling rationale for why the request is being made

DESCRIPTION OF COURSE CONTENT

Tentative Course Outline* (additional guidance to be provided on the Weekly Module pages of Canvas)

Date	Module	Module Title	Module Activities & Other Deadlines
Jan 12	"Start here"	Introduction to the Course	Read "Start Here" Section, Syllabus, & Using APA Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Introduce Yourself (4 pts)**
Jan 12-18 (Opens after M0 complete)	1	General Overview of Surveillance & Assessment	Read Soriano, Chapter 1 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Select Your Groupmates (4 pts)**
Jan 19-26 (Opens after M1 complete)	2	Cultural & Social Considerations	Read Soriano, Chapter 2 & 3 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Group Details (4 pts)** ***Suggested: Schedule your stakeholder interview for January 20- February 6***
Jan 27-Feb 1 (Opens after M2 complete)	3	Planning for Needs Assessments	Read Soriano, Ch. 4 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Group Assignment: Team Building Assignment (7 pts)**
Feb 2-8	4	Collaboration, Stakeholders, Community Engagement & Mobilization	Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Stakeholder Interview & Questions (9 pts)** **DUE: Brief Proposal (10 pts)**
Feb 9-16	**DUE:** Quiz 1		
Feb 17-22 (Opens after Quiz 1 complete)	5	Knowing the Public Health Issue	Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Identifying Peer-Reviewed Articles (9 pts)**
Feb 23-Mar 1	6	Collecting primary data: Overview of assessment methods	Review Canvas-provided readings and materials ***Suggested: Meet with your group to work on your Preliminary Needs Assessment!***
March 1	**DUE: Preliminary Needs Assessment (60 pts)**		

Mar 2-Mar 8 (Opens after M6 complete)	7	Quantitative Assessment Methods	Soriano Book Ch. 5 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Fix the Cruddy Items (0 pts, EC)** **Individual Assignment: Identifying Relevant Instruments (10 pts)**
Mar 9-14	8	Quantitative Data Prep & Analysis	Soriano Book Ch. 6 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Quantitative Analysis (0 pts, EC)**
Mar 15-22	**Spring Break**		
Mar 23- Mar 29 (Opens after Quiz 2 complete)	9	Qualitative Assessment Methods	Soriano Book Ch. 7 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials ***Suggested: Meet with your group to work on your project!***
Mar 29	**DUE:** Quiz 2		
Mar 30- Apr 5 (Opens after M9 complete)	10	Qualitative Data Prep and Analyses Mixed Methods	Soriano Book Ch. 8 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Qualitative Analysis (8 pts)**
Apr 6-12 (Opens after M10 complete)	11	Recruiting and Collecting Data from Participants	Soriano Book Ch. 9 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials **Individual Assignment: Partnership List & Recruitment Strategy (7 pts)**
Apr 13-20	12	Reporting Findings	Soriano Book Ch. 10 Review Canvas-provided readings and materials ***Suggested: Study for Quiz 3; Meet with your group to work on your project!***
Apr 26	**DUE:** Quiz 3		
April 26	**DUE: Needs/Capacity Assessment Proposal (100 pts)**		

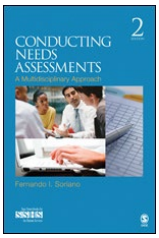
*The course outline and the terms of this syllabus (specifically the graded assignments) are subject to change. Any change to the syllabus will be posted as a Canvas announcement and with a revised version of the syllabus on Canvas. Please be sure you have Canvas notifications set up so you receive these announcements in a timely fashion.

Course Materials and Technology
This course will use the Canvas CMS. If you experience technical difficulties, please contact the UF Help Desk (learning-support@ufl.edu; 352-392-HELP – select option 2).

UF Internet (eduroam) is available at thousands of locations worldwide!
UF students can access eduroam (highspeed WiFi) for free with their GatorLink log-in credentials.
The eduroam network is fast and secure and has more than 10,000 wi-fi hotspots in 106 countries and territories worldwide. Many of these locations are in open spaces and/or large communal rooms, so you can get online while physically distancing and following CDC guidelines in an air-conditioned space. Access is available in rural areas, too! Here's a link to all the eduroam sites.

Instructional materials for this course consist of only those materials specifically reviewed, selected, and assigned by the instructor(s). The instructor(s) is only responsible for these instructional materials.

Required Readings:



Text: Soriano, F. I. (2012). *Conducting needs assessments: A multidisciplinary Approach.* Sage Publishing. ISBN-10: (Available in paperback, as an e-book, and in course reserves at the Health Science Center Library).

Paperback ISBN: 978-1-4129-6574-3 E-Book ISBN: 9781452225760

Check Canvas for additional required readings for each module.

Recommended**:

1. American Psychological Association. (2019). *The publication manual of the American Psychological Association (7th ed.). Author.*

   ***When writing papers in this program and in this profession, you are expected to write and format in APA style. I will provide you with resources to help with this; however, I highly recommend you purchase this book (or the pocket reference).*

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

Assignments

• Assessments (90 points): You will have 3 quizzes, each valued at 30. Assessments will primarily include closed-response items, and may include short answer items. You may be assessed on content from your assigned readings (textbook and supplemental), assigned videos, lectures and guest lectures, activities, assignments, as well as the projects.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Students requiring a make-up quiz may be required to instead complete an open-response assessment (i.e., short answer and essay question).

• Course Project Activities: You will work in teams of 3-4 (size may vary depending on our total class size) throughout the semester as you learn how to conduct community-focused and -engaged needs assessments. Based on expertise and interest, each team will select a population, health issue, and informational stakeholder. Review the 6251 Project Description document for more information, and each Canvas assignment for details. The major components of this team-based work include:

1. Brief Proposal (10 pts): In your brief, you will provide short, basic contextual information about your intention to conduct a needs assessment, including the priority population, health issue, and your intended stakeholder interview.

2. Preliminary Needs Assessment Report (55 pts): You will use Phases 1-3 of the PRECEDE PROCEED Model in developing this component. Your written report will include methods and results from your social diagnosis, a literature review, and rationale for conducting a more rigorous capacity needs assessment.

3. Needs & Capacity Assessment Proposal (100 pts): You will create a proposal to conduct a thorough and rigorous needs and capacity assessment.

**NOTE: You are expected to use the Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association (7th ed.) to format and write your papers.

• Other Assignments & Activities (80 pts): All students are expected to make informed contributions through class activities. To do this, students will need to prepare appropriately by viewing all assigned video presentations, completing weekly readings, and completing other weekly activities. The majority of these points will come from activities embedded within the weekly modules.

Grading

ASSIGNMENTS	Pts	Deadline
Quiz 1 (Modules 1, 2, 3, 4) Quiz 2 (Modules 4, 6, 7, 8) Quiz 3 (Modules 9, 10, 11, 12)	30 30 30	February 16 March 23 April 13
Course Project Assignments: 1. Brief Proposal 2. Preliminary Needs Assessment Report 3. Needs/Capacity Assessment Plan	 10 55 100	 February 9 March 2 April 27
Class Participation / Module Activities	80	Varies
TOTAL	335	

Grading Scale

Percent Earned	93-100	90-92	87-89	83-86	80-82	77-79	73-76	70-72	67-69	63-66	60-62	Below 60
Letter Grade	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-	E
Grade Points	4.0	3.67	3.33	3.0	2.67	2.33	2.0	1.67	1.33	1.0	.67	0

Please be aware that a C- is not an acceptable grade for graduate students. The GPA for graduate students must be 3.0 based on 5000 level courses and above to graduate. A grade of C counts toward a graduate degree only if based on credits in courses numbered 5000 or higher that have been earned with a B+ or higher. Information on current UF grading policies can be found at: https://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/graduate/regulations/#Grades

I. CLASS POLICIES

Assignment Policy: Be sure to review assignment descriptions in the course syllabus and in Canvas, and take note of any additional in-class guidance that is given for each assignment. Please note that important and helpful information about your assignments will be provided in class. Students are expected to do their best work and to turn in work on time. Some "deadlines" are self-imposed and will be determined by the specific assignment.

- Unless otherwise noted, assignments are due at 11:59pm on the date indicated. Please make efforts to turn assignments in early. **Make back-up copies of all your work**, as some assignments may not be returned and Canvas access may expire after the semester ends. All written work must be typed, unless otherwise indicated.
    - *Some assignments will not be accepted late. Others are subject to a 10% deduction in grade for every day it is late.* (Check assignment details in Canvas.)
    - I do recognize that personal circumstances arise (life happens) that may interfere with your ability to meet a deadline. If these unanticipated events do occur, please let me know as soon as possible. I will not be receptive to retrospective requests for extensions without a compelling rationale for why these requests are being made.

Course Evaluations: I value your professional and respectful feedback on the quality of instruction in this course. Please complete the evaluation for this course via the Canvas 'GatorEvals' tab or through https://ufl.bluera.com/ufl/. You will be notified when the evaluation period opens. UF provides guidance on how to give feedback in a professional and respectful manner. You can also view public summaries of course and instructor evaluation results.

Extra Credit Policy: There is no extra credit and there are no extra credit assignments. Additionally, no points will be "given" at the end of the semester. University Policy: Asking for extra points after your course is completed is an **HONOR OFFENSE.**

Make-up Policy: If a student fails to submit either a quiz or assignment on-time, they will be provided an opportunity to submit after the deadline provided they have an acceptable reason for missing the deadline. Decisions to allow students to make-up quizzes/exams after the deadline will be made by the course instructor after consulting the university-wide attendance policies specified in the UF Graduate Catalog.
Property of Course Content: The content presented in this version of PHC 6251 is the property of your instructor and the College of Public Health and Health Professions. Course content may not be duplicated in any format without the expressed written consent of the College of Public Health and Health Professions and the instructor, and may not be used for any commercial purposes. Students violating this policy may be subject to disciplinary action under the UF Conduct Code.

Title IX: University of Florida has zero tolerance for sexual discrimination, harassment, assault/battery, dating violence, domestic violence, or stalking. Students are encouraged to report any experienced or witnessed occurrences to law enforcement and/or one of UF's Title IX Coordinators. Students can report incidents or learn more about their rights and options here. Or contact Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution at 202 Peabody Hall, 352-392-1261.

Policy Related to AI Use in This Course *(optional)*

When authorized by the course director, students may use AI technologies in the completion of coursework as long as they cite all such use by naming the technology and how it was employed. Students assume full responsibility for all

content, including errors and omissions. Assistive technology authorized as part of an accommodation for a disability is always permitted.

Course instructors may adjust limitations on AI assistive technology use and must communicate any limitations to students sufficiently in advance of the assignment due date. Failure to cite the use of AI assistive technology, or use of the technology disregarding specific course limitations is considered academic misconduct. **The use of AI on assignments, essays/reflection papers, exams, and quizzes when prohibited by course or college instructions is considered cheating** and students are violating the UF Regulations 4.040 Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code.

It is important to note that many generative AI models (e.g. ChatGPT, ChatSonic, Google Bard etc) place any information that they are provided with into the public domain. When using such tools, you must therefore ensure that they are **never provided with confidential information**. UF AI systems (e.g., Co-Pilot, NaviGator) should never be provided with confidential information. For the avoidance of doubt, the use of such tools is prohibited for generating any confidential communications, including, but not limited to, communications relating to patient records, clients, students and intellectual property. You are also reminded that you should always review the terms and conditions of any third-party software you use (e.g. proof-reading tools) to ensure that any data they are provided with is appropriately protected. Always verify information and sources generated by AI tools. AI has been known to generate false information and to cite non-existent sources. Also, because AI-generated text mines people's intellectual property without appropriate credit, this raises ethical concerns.

It is not acceptable to use generative AI for reflective writing, as by its very nature, the process of reflective writing demands that you actively engage in the writing process. Delegating this to a natural language processing algorithm may produce convincing outputs but does not demonstrate development in your professional practice.

Students are responsible for understanding their dynamic data stewardship responsibilities to minimize personal, college, and university risk.
UF Integrated Risk Management – CHATGPT Privacy, Factual Accuracy and Usage Guidelines

ACADEMIC POLICIES & RESOURCES

University academic policies and resources can be found at: https://syllabus.ufl.edu/syllabus-policy/uf-syllabus-policy-links/

STUDENT EXPECTATIONS, ROLES, AND OPPORTUNITIES FOR INPUT

Expectations Regarding Course Behavior

To ensure that we have a great semester, remember --
All transactions and relationships are enriched by courtesy:
Be considerate of one another during group work. All ideas have merit.
Be considerate of your classmates and the professor during class meetings by being attentive, power-off technology, and be prepared to fully participate in each class.

Expectations & Online Classroom Ground Rules:

- Complete all work as assigned.
- Take responsibility for the quality of your learning experience.
- Build on one another's comments/ideas; seek to understand others' perspectives.
- Respectfully provide and receive specific, solution-oriented feedback.
- Communicate with your instructor and with your group members.

Academic & Personal Integrity: I expect and assume that you will be honest with me in all aspects of your conduct regarding our course. In return, I will do the same with you. By formally registering for coursework at the University of Florida, you are bound by the Honor Pledge which states:

> *"We, the members of the University of Florida community, pledge to hold ourselves and our peers to the highest standards of honesty and integrity by abiding by the Honor Code."* On all work submitted for credit at the University of Florida, the following pledge is either required or implied: *"On my honor, I have neither given nor received unauthorized aid in doing this assignment."*

The Honor Code specifies a number of behaviors that are in violation of this code and the possible sanctions. Furthermore, you are obligated to report any condition that facilitates academic misconduct to appropriate personnel. Violations of the Honor Code will not be tolerated. Violations will be reported to the Dean of Students Office for consideration of disciplinary action.

Communications Guidelines

Netiquette, Communication Courtesy: All members of the class are expected to follow rules of common courtesy in all email messages, threaded discussions and chats. I expect that students will show respect to their peers and instructor in all online communications. I will not tolerate improper language and disparaging comments; these actions will result in disciplinary action. Review this resource for information on the expected behavior of students when communicating with peers and instructors online.

PHHP Student Resources

PHHP's UPTurn (Unified Pathways to Support Wellness) program is a *no-cost mental health and wellness program* that is offered year-round to all PHHP students (undergraduate, graduate and professional level) and students (from any college) who are enrolled in PHHP courses. UPTurn advisors support students on their wellness journeys by curating individualized plans (resources and support) to help them manage academic, social, emotional, and health-related stress.

Interested students are paired with an UPTurn advisor, who meets with each student *virtually* (Zoom, Teams, phone) or *in person* (private office/room in HPNP) for a 45-minute consultation, followed by (if desired):

1. Up to 4 follow-up skills-building visits
2. When needed and appropriate, up to 10 psychotherapy sessions after completion of the 4 follow-up skills-building visits

Note: UPTurn is NOT a crisis/emergency resource. Students who are in crisis are strongly encouraged to use UF's existing crisis support resources, which are listed here: https://counseling.ufl.edu/services/crisis/

Students can learn more about UPTurn and request an appointment here: https://phhp.ufl.edu/student-resources/upturn-wellness-program/
Any questions regarding UPTurn can be directed to upturn@phhp.ufl.edu or (352) 273-6850.

Inclusive Learning Environment

Public health and health professions are based on the belief in human dignity and on respect for the individual. As we share our personal beliefs inside or outside of the classroom, it is always with the understanding that we value and respect diversity of background, experience, and opinion, where every individual feels valued. We believe in, and promote, openness and tolerance of differences in ethnicity and culture, and we respect differing personal, spiritual, religious and political values. We further believe that celebrating such diversity enriches the quality of the educational

experiences we provide our students and enhances our own personal and professional relationships. We embrace The University of Florida's Non-Discrimination Policy, which reads, "The University shall actively promote equal opportunity policies and practices conforming to laws against discrimination. The University is committed to non-discrimination with respect to race, creed, color, religion, age, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, marital status, national origin, political opinions or affiliations, genetic information and veteran status as protected under the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act."